MODULE 07

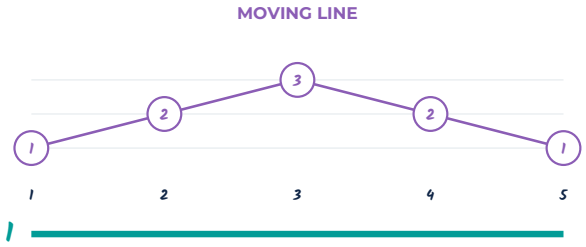
Pitch & Listening

Hear, remember, and coordinate comfortable pitches.



LISTEN FIRST | HUM: TWO BEATS | CHECK THE REFERENCE

One-Note Landing



Drone and Melody

TEN ACTIVITIES IN THIS MODULE

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70 Tune the Phrase Ending

Choose one goal. Try one illustrated task. Carry what works into your music.

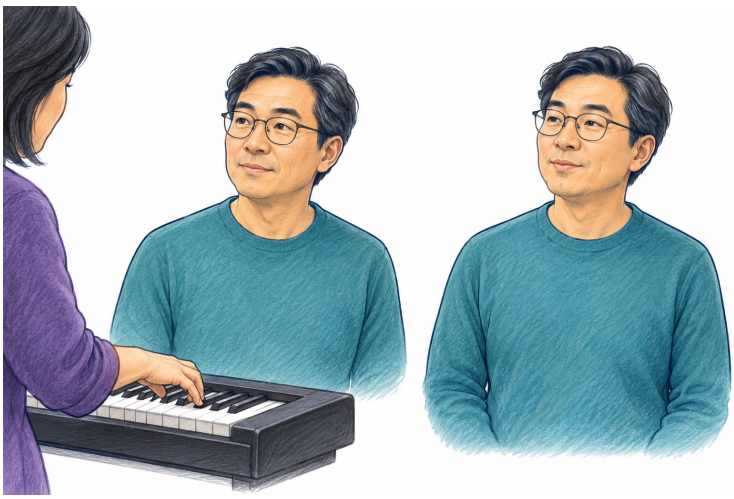
ACTIVITY 061

One-Note Landing

Pitch & Listening

4 minutes / Keyboard, tuning source, or a confident model.

Match a comfortable reference pitch after listening.



LISTEN FIRST | HUM: TWO BEATS | CHECK THE REFERENCE

Listen first; hum for two beats; hear the reference again before "oo".

1. *Play or sing one suitable middle-range note and ask everyone to listen before responding.*
2. *Hum it gently for two beats, stop, and hear the reference again.*
3. *Repeat on 'oo', allowing singers to change octave or listen until they find an easy match.*

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The group returns to the reference rather than drifting away after each attempt.

COMMON TRAP

Starting to sing before hearing the reference.

MAKE IT WORK

Use individual support privately; never ask a singer to push toward an uncomfortable note.

ACTIVITY 062

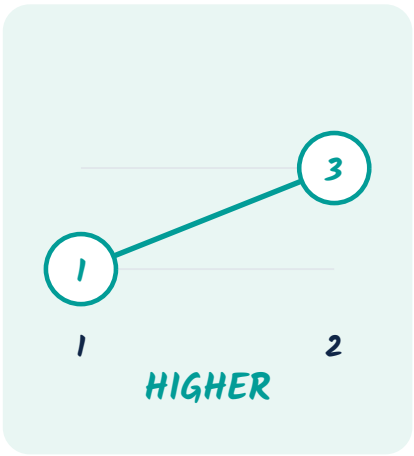
Higher, Lower, Same

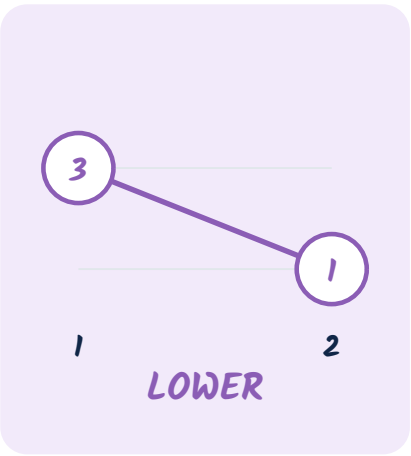
Pitch & Listening

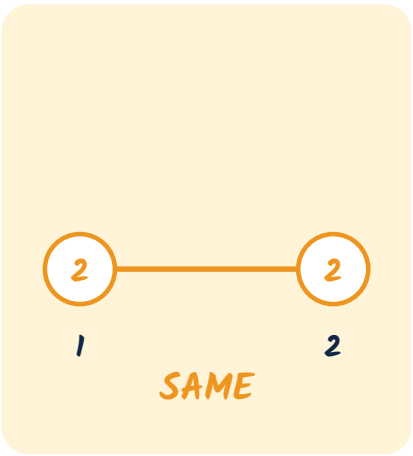
5 minutes / Three hand signs.

Recognize relative pitch direction before reproducing it.

Hear the pair. Show its direction. Then echo.







Identify the direction of each pair before singing it back.

1. *Sing two notes that are higher, lower, or the same; listeners respond with the agreed sign.*
2. *Give six mixed examples in a comfortable range and discuss any uncertain pair.*
3. *Let the choir echo the same pairs on 'loo' after identifying their direction.*

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The group identifies direction before attempting an echo.

COMMON TRAP

Echoing before identifying the direction.

MAKE IT WORK

Use larger pitch differences first; no individual singing is required.

ACTIVITY 063

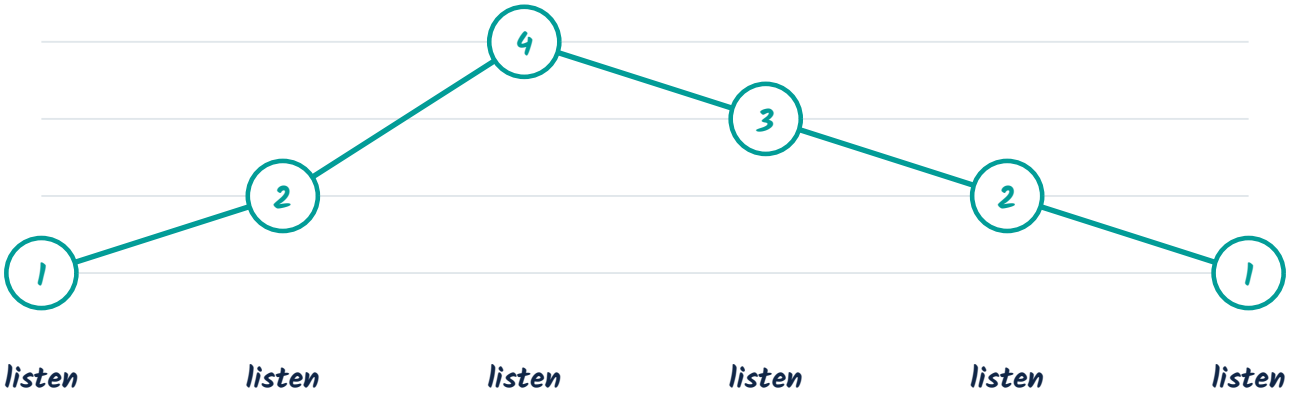
Melody Contour Map

Pitch & Listening

6 minutes / Paper and a short phrase.

Connect the shape of a melody to its sound.

Scale degrees in a comfortable key



Example contour: rise, turn, fall. Trace the model you actually hear.

1

Listen to a four- to six-note phrase without singing and trace its rise and fall with one hand.

2

Draw a simple line showing the direction changes; compare it with the model.

3

Sing the phrase while following the line, then look away and reproduce it once.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The drawn contour and sung direction agree at each turning point.

COMMON TRAP

Drawing a contour that disagrees with the model.

MAKE IT WORK

Use a two- or three-note contour and larger visual gestures.

ACTIVITY 064

Home Note Return

Pitch & Listening

5 minutes / Optional keyboard.

Keep the tonal home in mind during a short pattern.

Scale degrees in a comfortable key



The last note is home. Imagine it during the pause before checking the reference.

1. Establish a comfortable home note, then sing 1-2-3-2 and pause.
2. Invite the choir to supply the missing home note before hearing the reference again.
3. Try 1-3-5-3 and return home; rest between attempts and avoid range extremes.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The home note is stable after the intervening notes.

COMMON TRAP

Guessing the home note before imagining it.

MAKE IT WORK

Stay with 1-2-1 and let the director give the final note when needed.

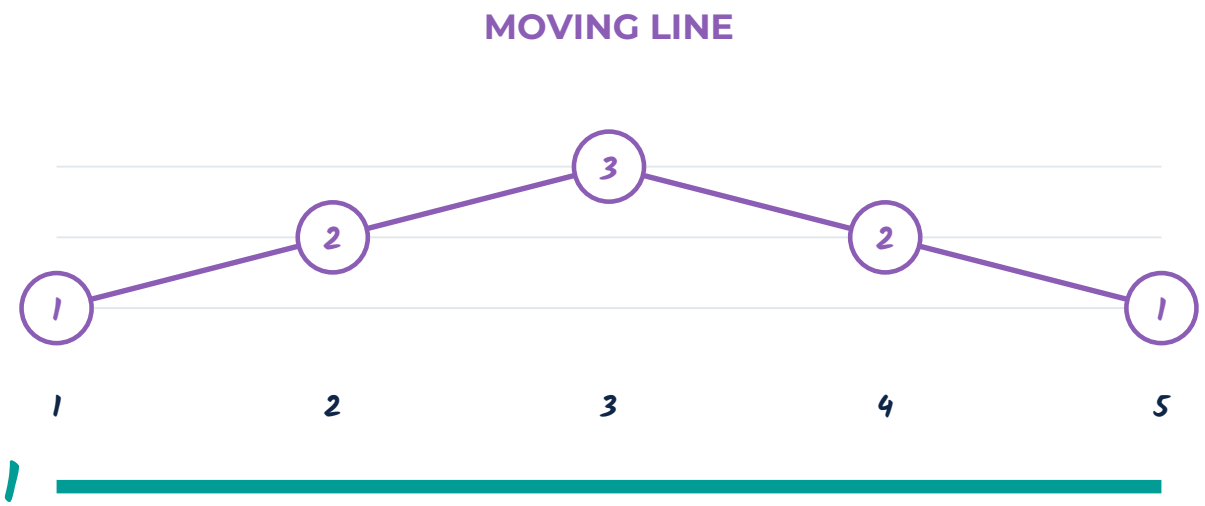
ACTIVITY 065

Drone and Melody

Pitch & Listening

6 minutes / Two groups and a short stepwise pattern.

Hear a melody against a quiet sustained reference.



GROUP A: gentle home note

A gentle home note supports the moving line; both groups stop and recover.

1. Group A sustains a gentle home note for four beats while B sings 1-2-3-2-1 at a manageable pace.
2. Stop, breathe normally, and exchange roles; nobody must sustain beyond comfort.
3. Ask singers which melody notes felt settled or unsettled against the home sound.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The reference remains soft enough for the moving line to be heard.

COMMON TRAP

Letting the drone cover the moving line.

MAKE IT WORK

The director or a keyboard supplies the drone so all singers can rest freely.

ACTIVITY 066

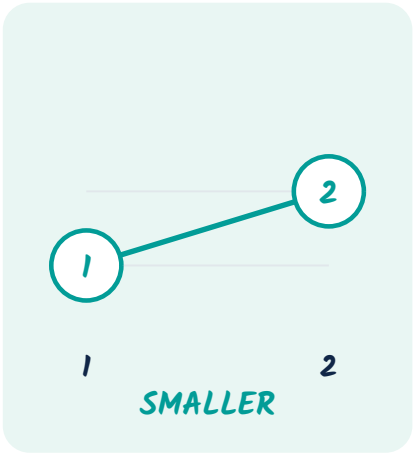
Interval Echo Pairs

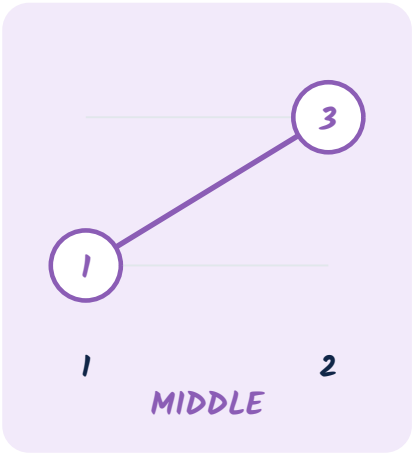
Pitch & Listening

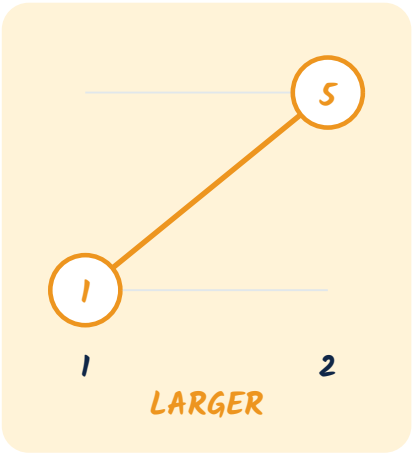
6 minutes / Comfortable two-note models.

Remember the distance between two notes without guessing from text.

Keep the starting note; compare the distance







Same starting note, three different distances. Model each pair before echoing.

1

Model 1-2, 1-3, and 1-5 separately, giving a rest after each pair.

2

Let the group echo and describe whether the distance feels small, medium, or larger.

3

Mix the three examples and then find one matching distance in current repertoire.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The response preserves the interval instead of only its general upward direction.

COMMON TRAP

Remembering only that every pair goes upward.

MAKE IT WORK

Use only 1-2 and 1-3 until they are secure; change octave if appropriate.

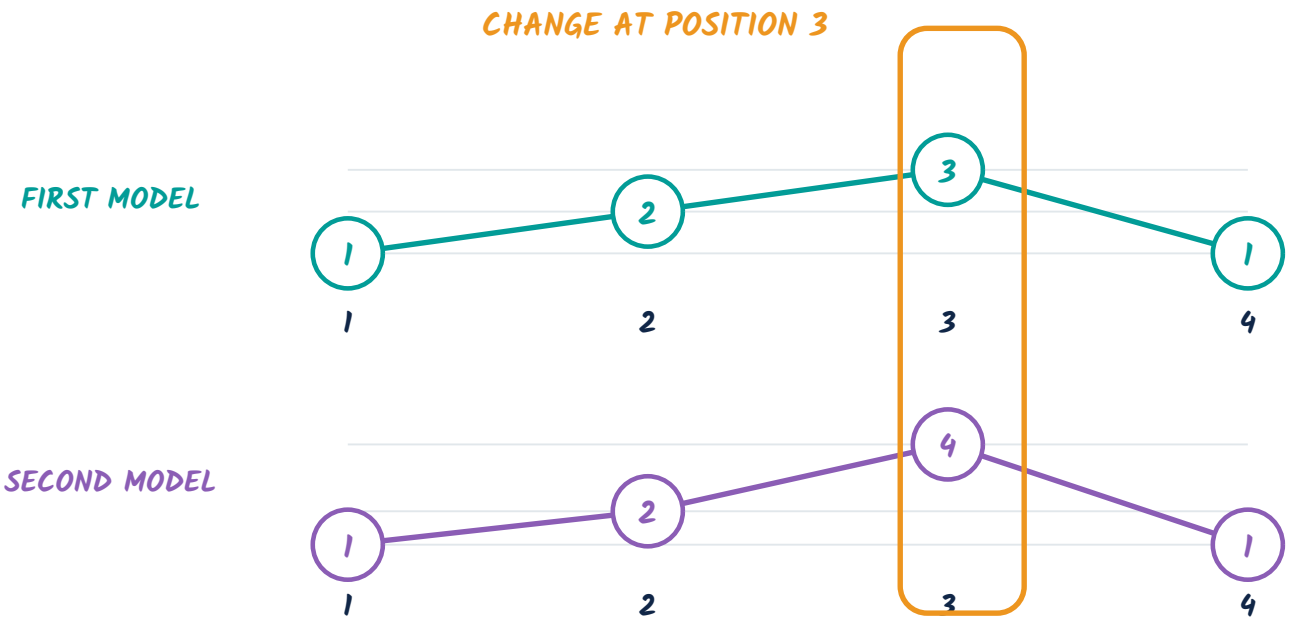
ACTIVITY 067

Find the Different Note

Pitch & Listening

6 minutes / A prepared four-note phrase.

Detect a changed pitch by comparing two short versions.



Position 3 changes; the first, second and final notes stay the same.

1

Sing 1-2-3-1 and ask the choir to listen without responding.

2

Sing 1-2-4-1 and let partners identify which position changed, using fingers or words.

3

Rehearse the original, then compare a similar trouble spot in the repertoire.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

Listeners identify the changed position rather than simply saying one version was wrong.

COMMON TRAP

Saying a version was wrong without locating the change.

MAKE IT WORK

Show four blank boxes and point to each note while it sounds.

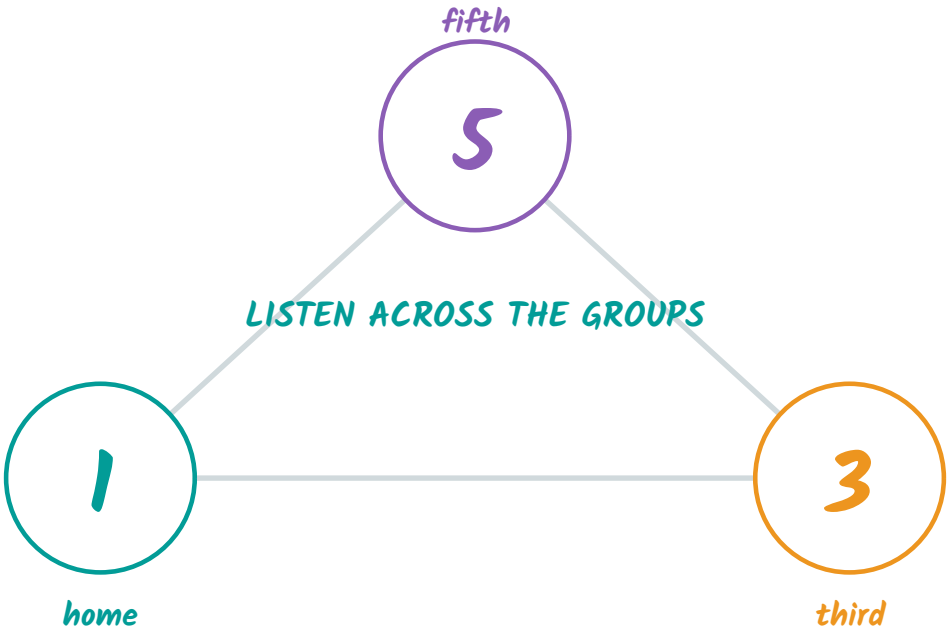
ACTIVITY 068

Chord Listening Triangle

Pitch & Listening

7 minutes / Three groups; optional keyboard.

Balance three chord tones by listening across the ensemble.



Build a comfortable major chord one group at a time, with short holds and normal breaths.

1

Assign home, third, and fifth of a comfortable major chord to three groups and establish each note separately.

2

Build the chord one group at a time at gentle volume, with short holds and normal breaths.

3

Ask the newest group to listen before joining; rotate roles where ranges allow.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

Singers adjust volume so all parts are audible without forcing a perfect blend.

COMMON TRAP

Forcing a fixed chord tone into an unsuitable range.

MAKE IT WORK

Use two notes or let a keyboard provide one part; do not force fixed voice ranges.

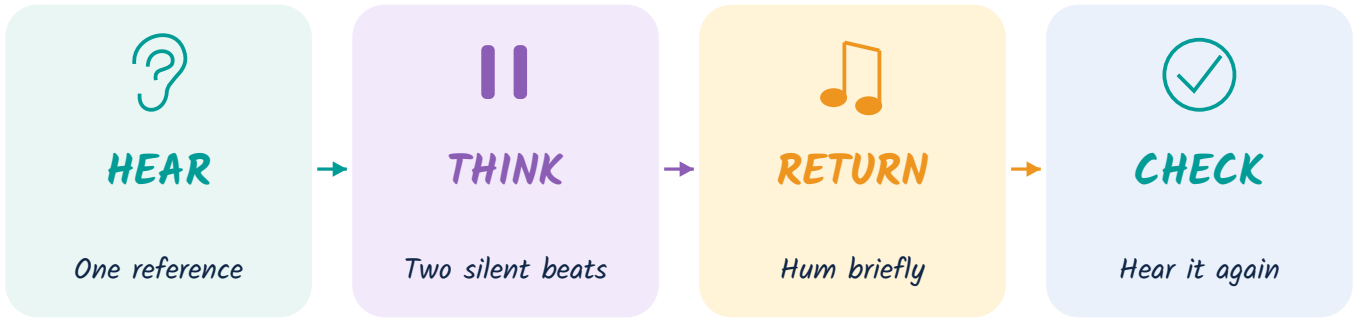
ACTIVITY 069

Silent Pitch Recall

Pitch & Listening

5 minutes / One reference pitch.

Recall a starting pitch after a brief period of silence.



Hear / imagine during two silent beats / return / compare with the reference.

1. Hear a comfortable note, sing it for two beats, then rest for two silent beats.
2. Think the note without humming, then sing it again and compare with the reference.
3. Extend the silent gap to four beats only after the shorter version is reliable.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The returning pitch remains close to the reference without audible rehearsal in the gap.

COMMON TRAP

Audibly rehearsing during the silent gap.

MAKE IT WORK

Keep a very short gap or use a hand sign showing the imagined note.

ACTIVITY 070

Tune the Phrase Ending

Pitch & Listening

6 minutes / Last two bars of a song.

Stabilize a closing note within its musical context.

LAST NOTE

Hear the target

→

LAST TWO WORDS

Keep the approach

→

FULL ENDING

Sing it in context

Build the ending backwards in useful units, then test it in the whole phrase.

1. Hear and sing the final note in a comfortable key; notice its place in the phrase.
2. Sing backward from the ending in small units: last word, last two words, then the full closing line.
3. Compare the final pitch to a reference after the complete phrase rather than stopping early to correct it.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The last note is secure when approached through its actual melody.

COMMON TRAP

Securing an isolated final note but never its approach.

MAKE IT WORK

Shorten the phrase and use a slower tempo or octave alternative.